Harbourline Advisory Pty Ltd (fictional): Client Engagement and Document Policy

Version 3.2, effective 1 July 2026. Internal document. All rules below are fictional.

1. Onboarding

Every new client must sign an engagement letter before any work begins. The engagement letter must be countersigned by a director of the firm. Identity verification must be completed for every individual client and for every director of a company client.

2. Document deadlines

Clients must upload all source documents for an annual return within 10 business days of the document request being sent. If documents are not received by the deadline, the assigned accountant sends one reminder, and the job is placed on hold after a further 5 business days.

3. Review and sign-off

All returns are prepared by an accountant and reviewed by a second person before lodgement. Returns for businesses with annual turnover above $2,000,000 must also be reviewed by a director. Any return that claims a deduction above $50,000 for a single item requires a written file note explaining the basis of the claim.

4. Fees

The standard fee for an individual tax return is $330 including GST. A sole trader return is $770 including GST. Company returns are quoted individually. Invoices are payable within 14 days of the invoice date.

5. Record retention

Client working papers are retained for 7 years from the date of lodgement. After 7 years they are securely destroyed unless the client has an open dispute or audit.

6. Use of AI tools

AI tools may only be used on synthetic or de-identified data unless the client has given written consent. Any figure produced by an AI tool must be checked against the source document by the preparing accountant before it is used in a return.